



SWARMING HORDES

The big animals of the savanna are massively outnumbered by insects. These include dung beetles that recycle the droppings of the grazing herds, and termites that live in large earth mounds that rise above the plains. Sometimes, swarms of locusts descend on the savanna trees, stripping them of every leaf.

► FOOD RECYCLERS

Dung beetles eat half-digested animal waste, and also store it underground as food for their young.



▼ SUPERCHARGERS

Cheetahs can sprint at an astonishing 75 mph (120 km/h) in short bursts—faster than any other land animal.



FAST FACTS

- A baobab tree can store up to 32,000 gallons (120,000 liters) of water in its trunk.
- Wildebeests have been recorded migrating in herds of more than 10,000 animals.
- A cheetah can accelerate faster than a high-powered sports car.
- A single locust swarm can cover an area the size of a large city.

POWERFUL PREDATORS

On the African plains, the grazing animals are preyed upon by fast, powerful hunters. These include lions, leopards, cheetahs, wild dogs, and spotted hyenas. This is why many of the grazers, such as zebras and gazelles, have evolved the ability to run fast. The plains also support scavengers, including jackals and vultures, who feed on the remains of dead animals.

